Staff answers

Friday 5 March 2027 · P1 · 40 minutes · Year A

Careers · LAUNCH · pair · Spring 2 Week 2 · Theme Resilience & Change

Exact scheme outcomes

Pay, payslips & deductions (links Maths).

Suggested answers concern invented examples. They are not learner observations or automatic judgements. Accept any safe, accurate explanation supported by the source.

Model and scenario keys

Practice month A: gross £1,000; tax £100; NI £50; total deductions £150; net £850. Gross is before deductions; net is after. Check £850 + £150 = £1,000. Supplied tax and NI figures are invented, not real rates.

Practice month B: total deductions £120 and net £680. Accept subtraction in two steps (£800 - £80 = £720; £720 - £40 = £680), or subtraction of the total. Add-back £680 + £120 = £800. Credit the meaning and method separately from an arithmetic slip.

Check slip: total deductions £90, calculated net £510, printed net £520, mismatch £10. A sensible question is: Please explain the net-pay line. I subtracted £60 and £30 from £600 and got £510, but the slip says £520. Accept any calm, specific question and a plan to keep the record and ask the person responsible for pay privately.

CfU: £850 net, after deductions. Main hinge C; parallel hinge A (£430). For each learner record their own initial choice and any help used; do not infer one partner's understanding from the other's answer.

Aspire: deductions can differ, so equal gross pay need not give equal net pay. No current rates or personal circumstances are required. Arithmetic balance alone cannot confirm real tax or NI correctness. Do not teach that all workers always pay the same deductions or that every payslip contains only two deductions.

Evidence may be written, spoken with an exact scribe and readback, pointed or produced with an agreed aid. Retain labels, a calculation or described method, the check, and a sensible private question. A copied model is not evidence of the learner's own calculation.

Practice month A

Gross £1,000; tax £100; NI £50; net £850. What do the four labels mean, and do the supplied lines balance?

Suggested answer: Gross is before deductions. Tax and NI are the two labelled deductions. Net is after deductions. Total deductions are £150 and £1,000 - £150 = £850, so these lines balance. The £150 is taken off, not added to gross pay. Balancing supplied figures is an arithmetic check only.

Practice month B

Gross £800; tax £80; NI £40. Find total deductions and net pay. Check the result.

Suggested answer: £80 + £40 = £120. £800 - £120 = £680 net pay. £680 + £120 = £800. Add all the supplied deductions before subtracting from gross pay; include NI as well as tax.

Check slip

Gross £600; tax £60; NI £30; printed net £520. Does the arithmetic match? What would be a sensible next action?

Suggested answer: £60 + £30 = £90; £600 - £90 = £510. The printed £520 is £10 higher. Keep the slip and ask the person responsible for pay to explain the difference privately. Identify the specific mismatch without guessing its cause or sharing personal pay details with the group.

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Checks evidence and misconceptions

Check after I do

On practice month A, which is the amount left after the two supplied deductions: £1,000 or £850? Explain the label.

£850. It is net pay, which is the amount after deductions. £1,000 is gross pay, before deductions.

Main hinge

Practice month B shows gross £800, tax £80 and NI £40. Which calculation finds net pay?

A £800 + £80 + £40 = £920

B £800 - £80 = £720

C £800 - (£80 + £40) = £680

Key: C. Each learner answers privately. If either adds deductions or omits NI, re-model the labelled lines, let the learner subtract both amounts with an aid, then use the parallel hinge. Continue to the independent task after the learner explains net as after deductions; otherwise retain the supported frame and adult check.

Parallel hinge

A new invented slip shows gross £500, tax £50 and NI £20. What is net pay?

A £430

B £450

C £570

Key: A. £50 + £20 = £70; £500 - £70 = £430. If the answer is still unclear, read and match one labelled line at a time, use the supported frame and record the help used. Do not give the answer then mark it independent.

Misconceptions

Mistaken idea	Correction
Gross pay is the amount left after deductions.	Gross is before deductions. Net is after. Point back to both labels and compare the amounts.
Tax is the only deduction, so ignore the NI line.	Read every supplied deduction label. In these examples both tax and NI are subtracted. Other real payslips may contain other deductions.
If the numbers add up, the real tax and NI must be correct.	The check only tests arithmetic using the supplied figures. A real query needs the actual record and an explanation from the appropriate pay contact.

Judgement and feedback

Review the learner’s own reasoning, source use and safe action. Do not infer competence from attendance, confidence, reading fluency or a partner’s answer. Classroom evidence cannot prove real employment, pay entitlement or a completed placement. VF verbal feedback · WS worked with support · I independent · NS next step · // self-edit · ? read this back to me · E saved evidence · R responded. Keep the first try, one NS and the learner reply. Record R only after Voice and Audience are clear and the learner responds to NS in the same colour, on the same page or usual mode. Offer to the Communication portfolio. Staff confirm any mapping to the unit award; no award completion is implied.

Use voice, writing, pointing, a usual aid, typing or an exact scribe. Read back and correct. Plan in any language. Ask a trusted adult privately; pass, pause and return with support. No personal work or family story is needed.

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